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Read less news

Good morning, Pro Briefers!

Spin classes and cardio used to be the biggest names in weight loss. Now, it's Ozempic, which is produced by Novo Nordisk (NVO).

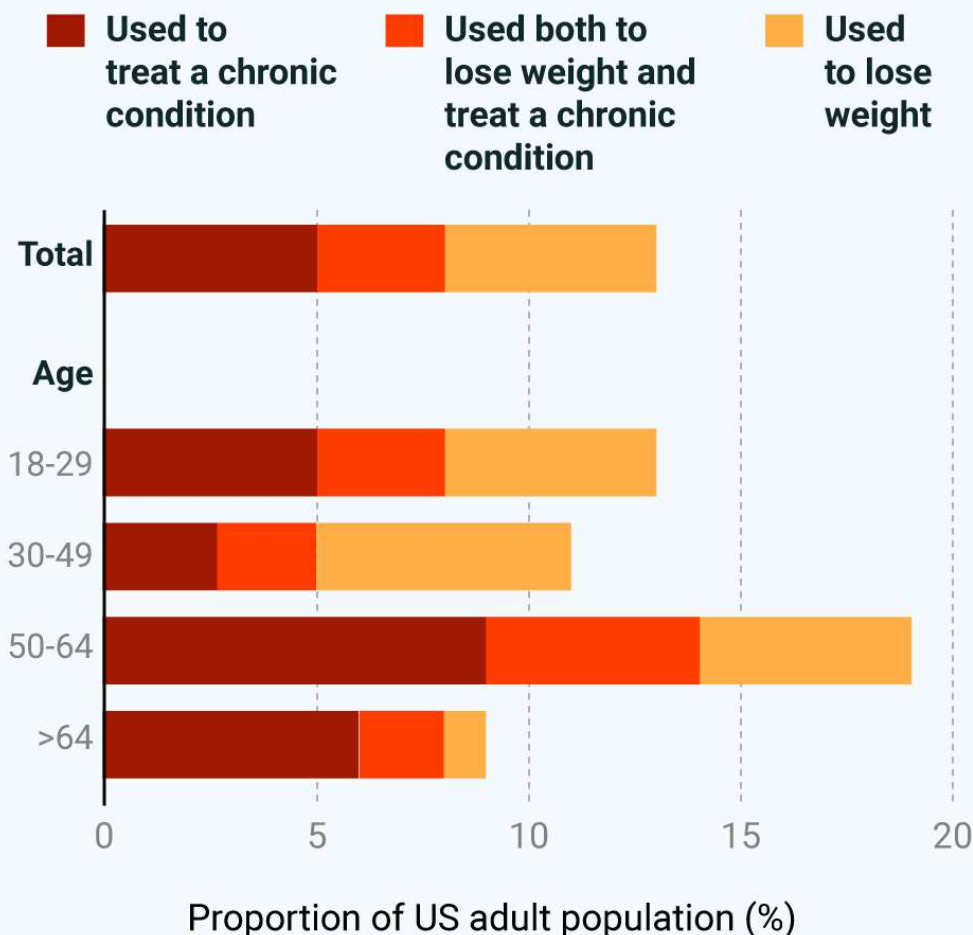
These medicines are known as GLP-1s or semaglutides. The popularity of GLP-1s has created huge gains for Novo and the other companies producing them.

- Novo Nordisk earned \$17 billion from Ozempic sales in 2024.

Eli Lilly (LLY), who sells a competitor weight loss medicine, Mounjaro, earned \$11.54 billion from the sale of that medicine in 2024.

UPTAKE OF GLP-1 DRUGS IN THE UNITED STATES

One in eight adults say that they have used GLP-1 agonists, either to lose weight or treat diabetes or heart disease.



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Data via Nature

But it's actually the *P* in GLP that makes these medicines so powerful - and it's where we've identified an Innovation Shift:

Peptides changed weight loss with GLP-1s. Now, companies are creating more medicines with peptides to change other aspects of our health.

Our research leads us to believe that companies using peptides for hormone production, skin rejuvenation, and wound healing will see an increase in revenue as new innovations in peptides are being produced.

But first: The P in GLP stands for peptides.

Peptides are basically tiny proteins in our body that tell our cells what to do. Our bodies already naturally produce peptides.

These peptides can be customized in labs though, and then introduced to our bodies to help change our cells in many different ways.

In the case of weight loss, these peptides regulate when you're hungry, your digestion, sugar production, and more.

Types of Peptides



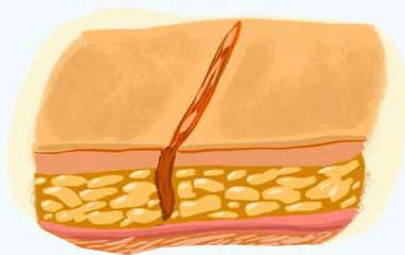
Vasopressin:

Regulate water in fluid surrounding cells



Oxytocin:

Create feelings of love and bonding



Defensins:

Help with wound-healing



Angiotensins:

Regulate blood pressure

Researchers have now discovered that peptides can do more than help people lose weight.

Peptides are being used to make us look younger, heal our wounds faster, and even produce hormones better than our body can.

The opportunity? New products containing custom peptides have the ability to do it more efficiently.

We spoke to Dr. Cristina Del Toro Badessa, who is also an expert in peptides, in an exclusive interview to learn more about this shift.

"I think that the peptides themselves give the body back something that it needs and people just heal and recover and respond in pretty incredible ways." - Dr. Del Toro Badessa.

- There are now over 100 FDA approved uses for peptide products and medicines outside of weight loss, up from just four in 2022.

Demand for GLP-1s has proven that peptides are a powerful tool.

Now, with peptides being used to solve other medical needs, investors may be able to profit by investing in the companies producing these new innovations.

Our team got the inside scoop: We spoke to an expert in the peptides space to find more opportunities - [watch the full interview here](#).

HORMONAL HEALTH

Biohacking the Body's Signals

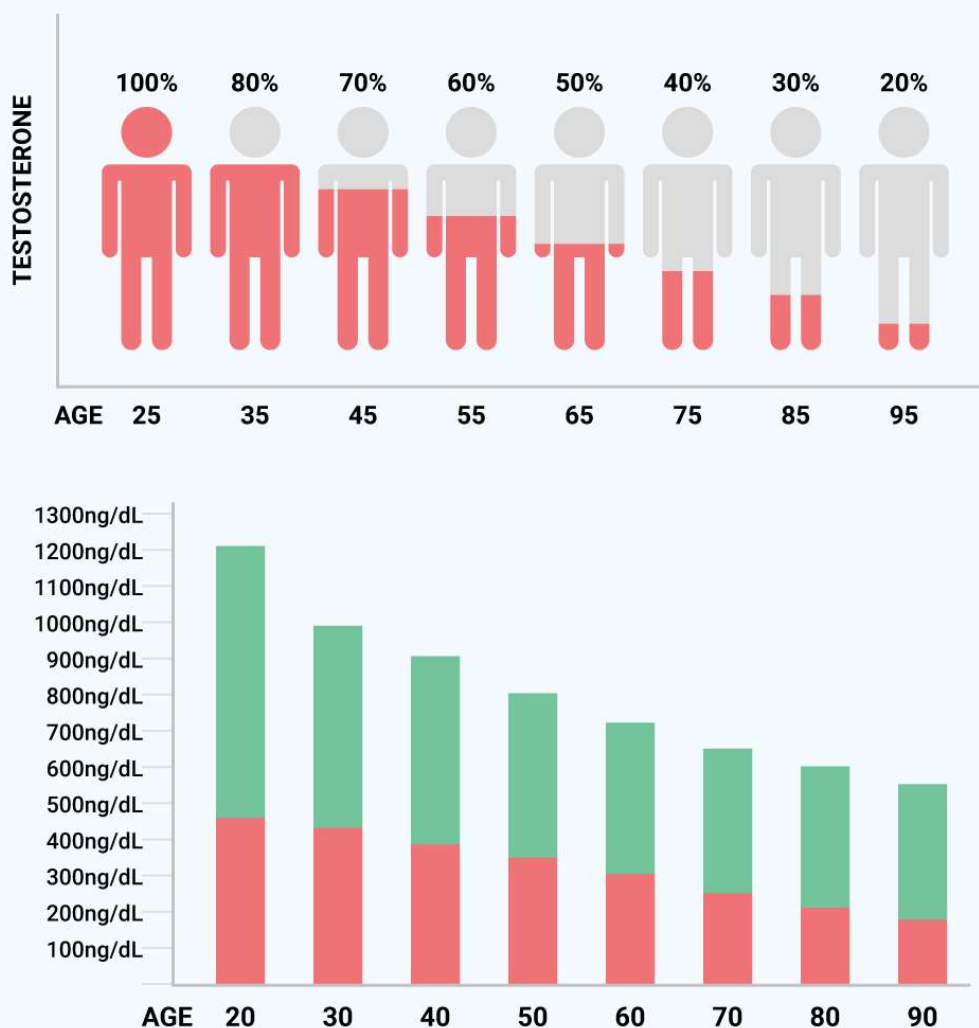
Fact: As people age, testosterone levels in the body naturally decrease.

Some studies even suggest that testosterone in men has been falling among all age groups over the last 40 years.

Now, we're not doctors - but, testosterone is a hormone, and peptides have been found to help stimulate hormone production in our bodies.

Only Acesis Holdings, a private company, has been able to crack the code on this so far - bringing its peptide medicine for testosterone production to clinical trials this year.

Max and Min Testosterone Level by Age



Market Briefs Pro

Data via Muscle and Brawn

- Acesis Holdings has filed to become public in the U.S., but has not set its official IPO date as of this report's publishing date.

However, hormones that play a role in energy production, metabolism, estrogen, and more can also be stimulated by peptide medicine or products.

"Hormone health is so complicated. If peptides could replace estrogen or come alongside it, that would be awesome. That would be a great thing to see." - Dr. Del Toro Badessa.

The point? If our bodies are not producing enough hormones, introducing custom peptides may be able to help.

AbbVie (ABBV) is creating therapeutic medicines in the peptide space, many of which focus on autoimmune diseases, cancer, and brain hormone imbalances.

How? In December 2024, AbbVie acquired Nimble Therapeutics for \$200 million - Nimble is currently in preclinical trials for its oral peptide medicine.



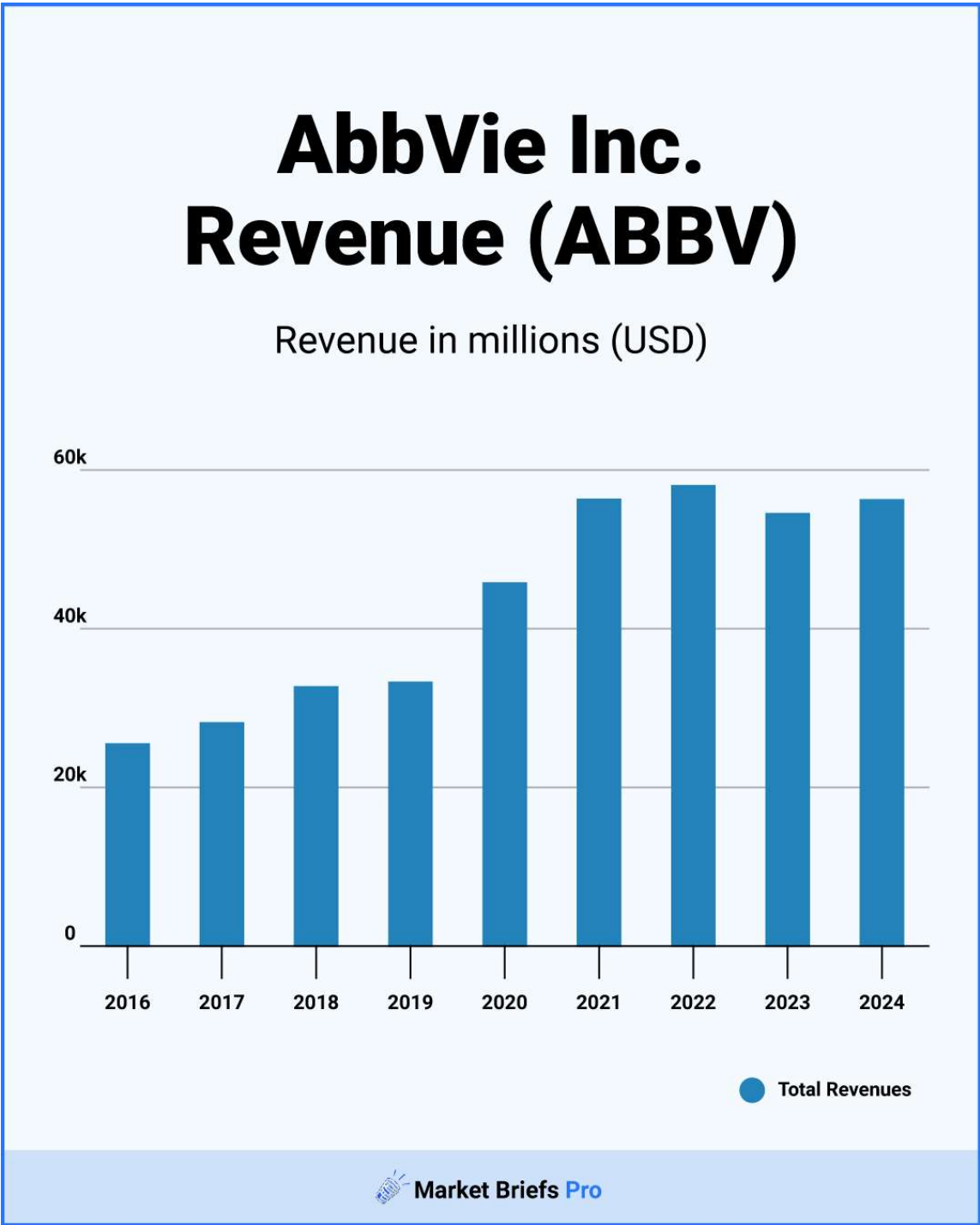
Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- Roughly 5-8% of the world's population has an autoimmune disease, where the body essentially attacks itself.

Nimble and AbbVie's peptide medicine tells the cells not to attack the body.

But because these medicines can be given orally, that gives them a huge advantage in the space, as over 75% of peptide medicines must be injected.

AbbVie earned \$56 billion in revenue in 2024, up 3.3% year-over-year, with \$3 billion coming from its immunology segment, which includes peptides.



Data [via](#) company 10-K

Other companies have already been able to bring products to market in this space though - like Amgen (AMGN).

It currently boasts 14 medicines that are available today that help with hormonal conditions affecting the heart, bone diseases, and more.

- Just from its peptides, the company earned over \$7 billion in sales in 2024.



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

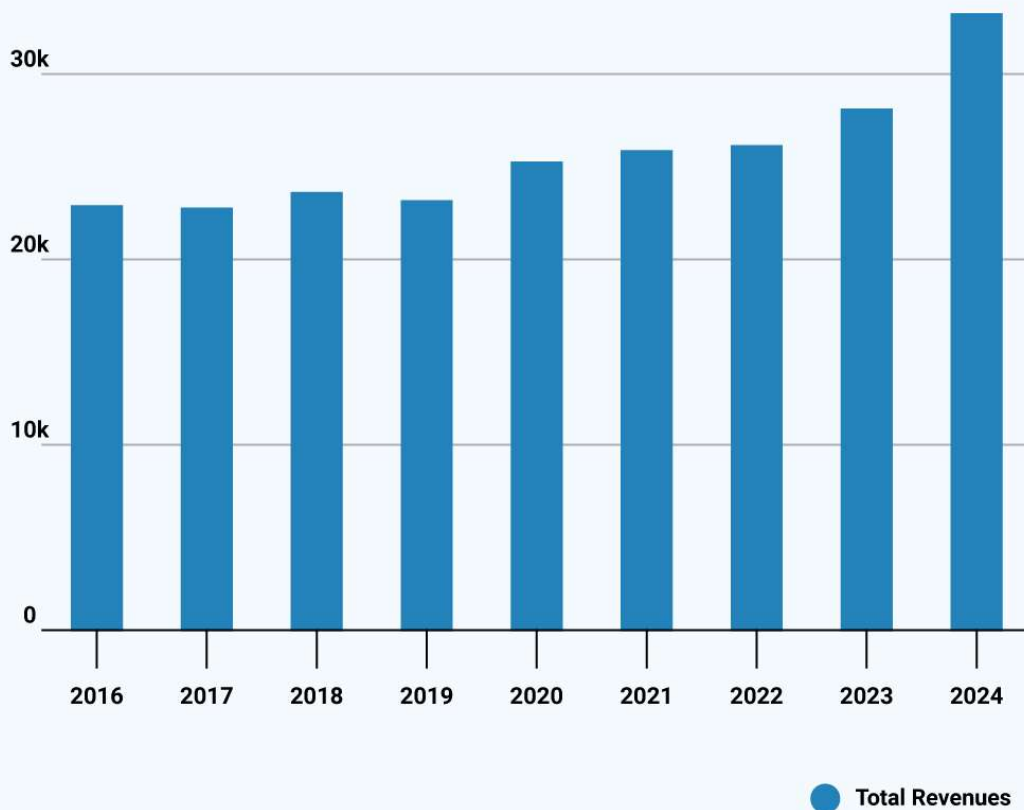
These medicines use peptides to modify our biology, like hormones in our thyroid, which are critical for maintaining a healthy heart.

Amgen also holds a significant portion of the peptide industry as a whole as of 2025, with Precedence Research estimating it controls 40% of the industry.

That's allowed it to also enter into the GLP space for weight loss as well with MariTide, which is currently in the testing phase.

Amgen Inc. Revenue (AMGN)

Revenue in millions (USD)



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Data [via](#) company 10-K

There are currently no ETFs that focus solely on peptide-creating companies, but investors can play this opportunity with stocks like Amgen and AbbVie, should demand for their products rise.

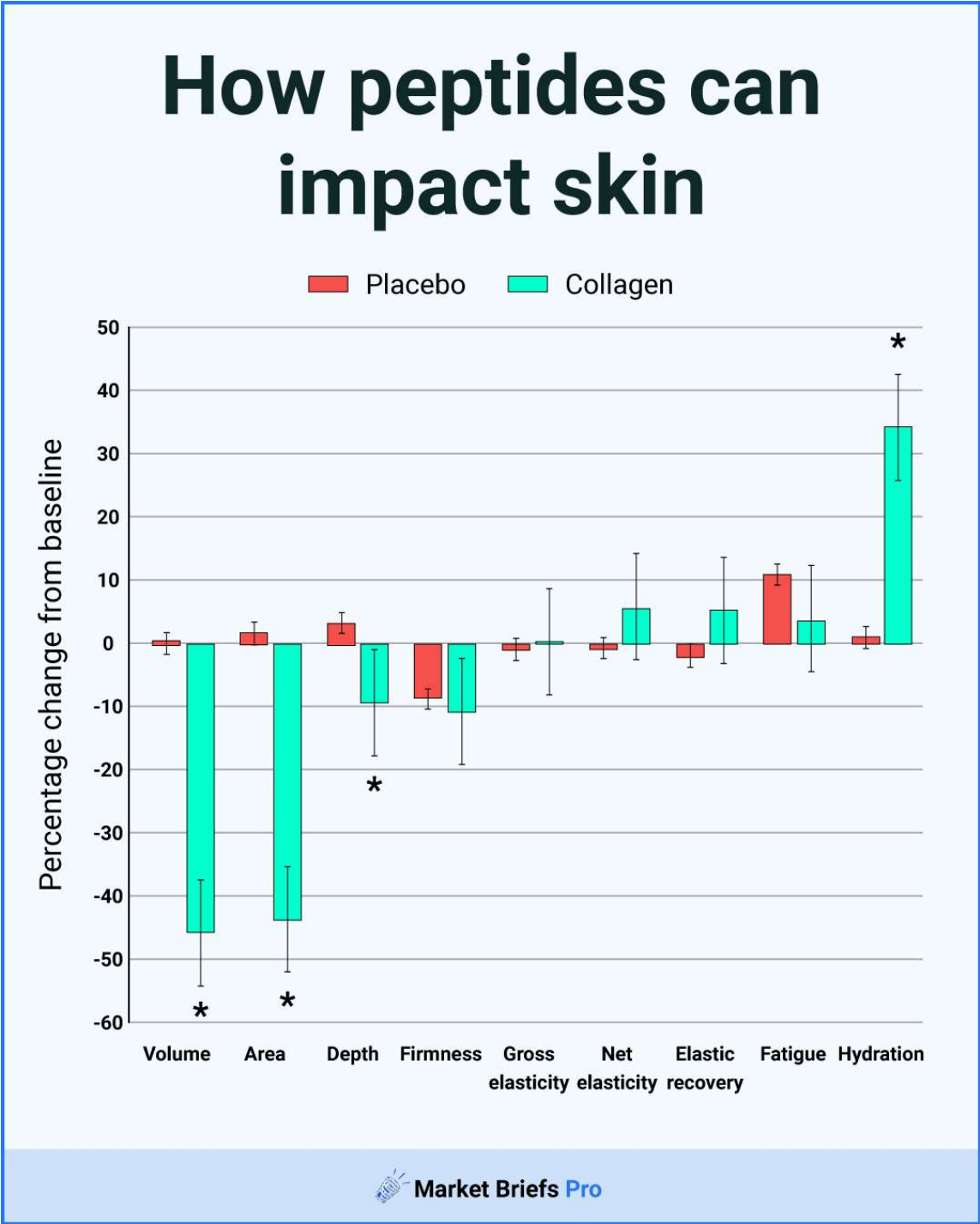
SKIN REJUVENATION

The Fountain of Youth?

Peptides have been effective for treatments inside the body - but peptides are also being used on the outside of our bodies as well.

Studies have shown peptides used in things like topical creams can increase collagen production in our skin: reducing wrinkles, increasing hydration, and making skin stronger.

And over time, the use of peptides for our skin may help train our cells, effectively delaying the cosmetic effects of aging.



Data via MDPI

That has led to a rise in peptides used in skincare products and new innovations from cosmetic brands.

That's even part of the reason a lot of our skincare is so effective right now, according to Dr. Del Toro Badessa,

"You need medical grade skin care with really good carriers and even some of your drugstore skincare has peptides in it now. Peptides are in our skincare, and effective skincare has peptides."

Estée Lauder (EL) has been a leader in the peptide skincare space for over 40 years - they've been testing the substance in their products for at least that long.

But, it was only until recently that they have been able to release products with peptides in them.

Its exclusive Night Peptide product is meant to be applied at nighttime, healing the skin as we sleep.

- The formula is even patented, meaning it's only available for use by Estée Lauder.

Once again, we're not doctors - but the use of peptides in this product has driven demand for it.

The Estée Lauder Companies Inc. (EL)

YTD Price



86.61
(15.46%)



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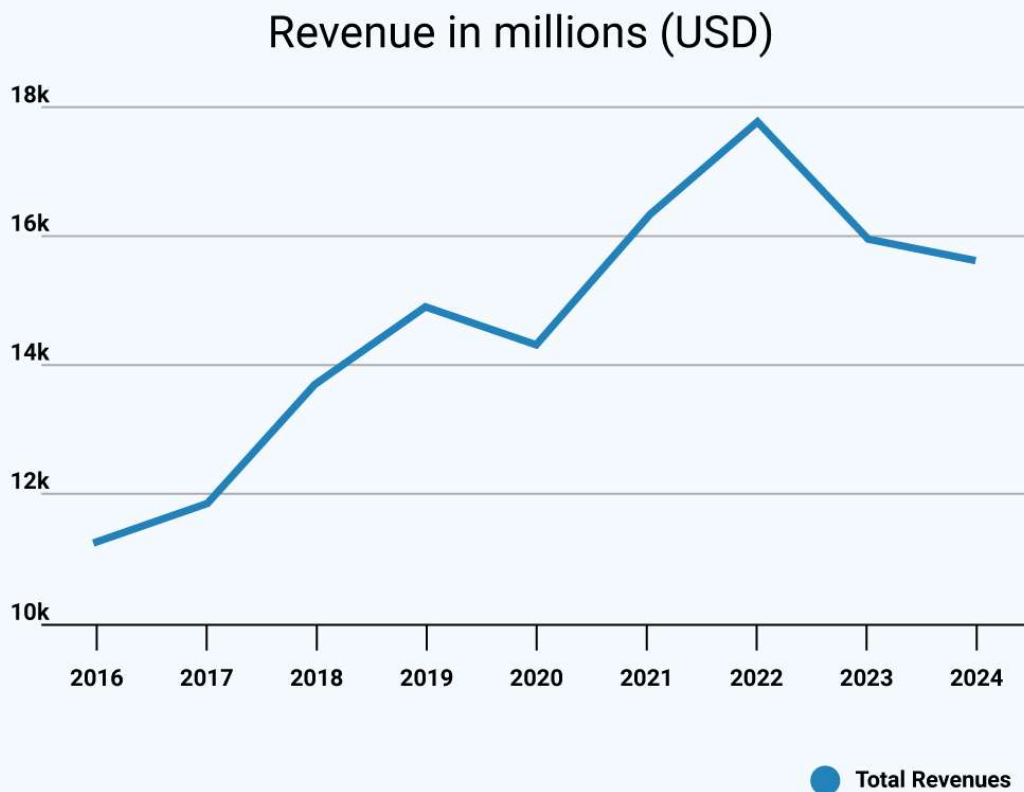
Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Estée Lauder mentioned that this nighttime peptide product was a significant contributor to its skincare segment in 2024, which is where the company earns 50% of its revenue.

Overall, sales for Estée Lauder did fall 2% in 2024, mainly due to a decline in its Asian market.

But, it does plan on releasing more peptide related products this year and in the future, which shows demand in this segment is growing.

The Estée Lauder Companies Inc. Revenue (EL)



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Data [via](#) company 10-K

Even if you don't have a skincare routine, you may be using peptides on a daily basis already, and not even know it...

That's because peptides are also being added to products we use every day - like hand soaps, colognes, perfumes, and more.

Unilever (UL) has been slowly introducing peptides into its products over the last few years, particularly with its Dove brand.

Its soaps and lotions can be used on our hair and skin to repair damage - peptides repair the damaged cells and speed up the process.

- 89% of those using the products have reported stronger, healthier hair, according to surveys from Unilever.



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

The science aside - peptide products have been a big revenue driver for the company.

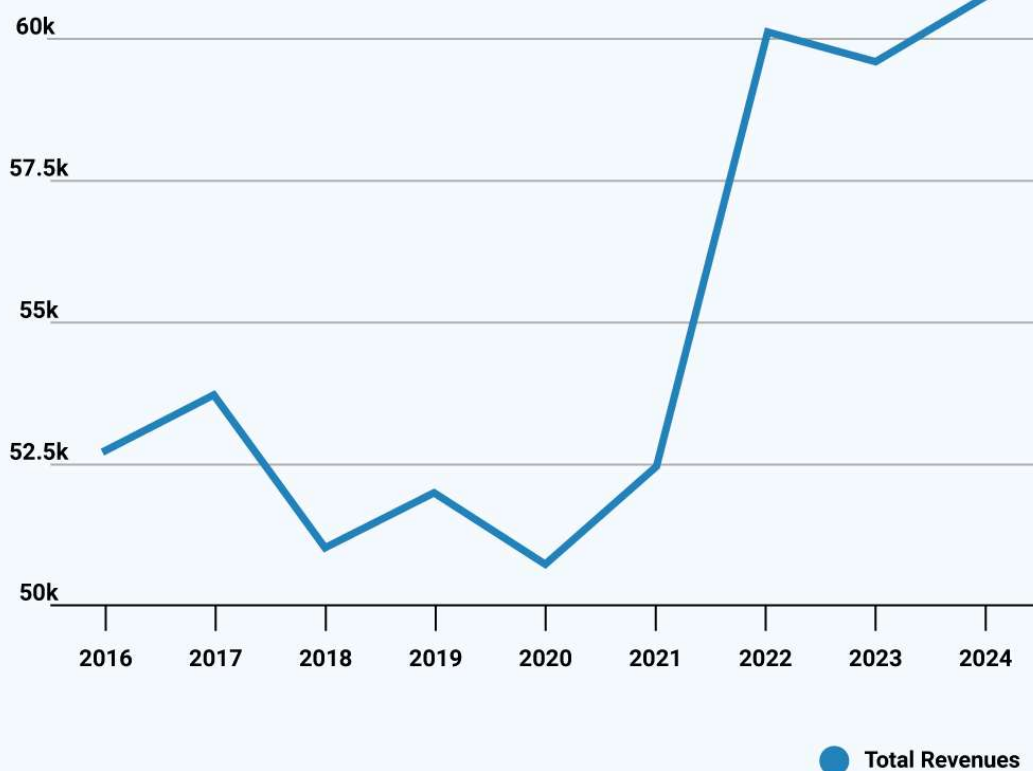
Its Prestige Beauty business, which uses peptides, brought in \$1.6 billion in 2023.

Overall, Unilever earned \$71 billion in total revenue last year, a 2% increase year-over-year. And it's now one of the top 5 cosmetics companies in the peptide space by total sales.

There are several general ETFs that contain skincare and other cosmetic brands, but no specific ones that feature peptide companies, as this shift has not hit the mainstream yet.

Unilever PLC Revenue (UL)

Revenue in millions (Euro)



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Data [via](#) company 10-K

WOUND MANAGEMENT

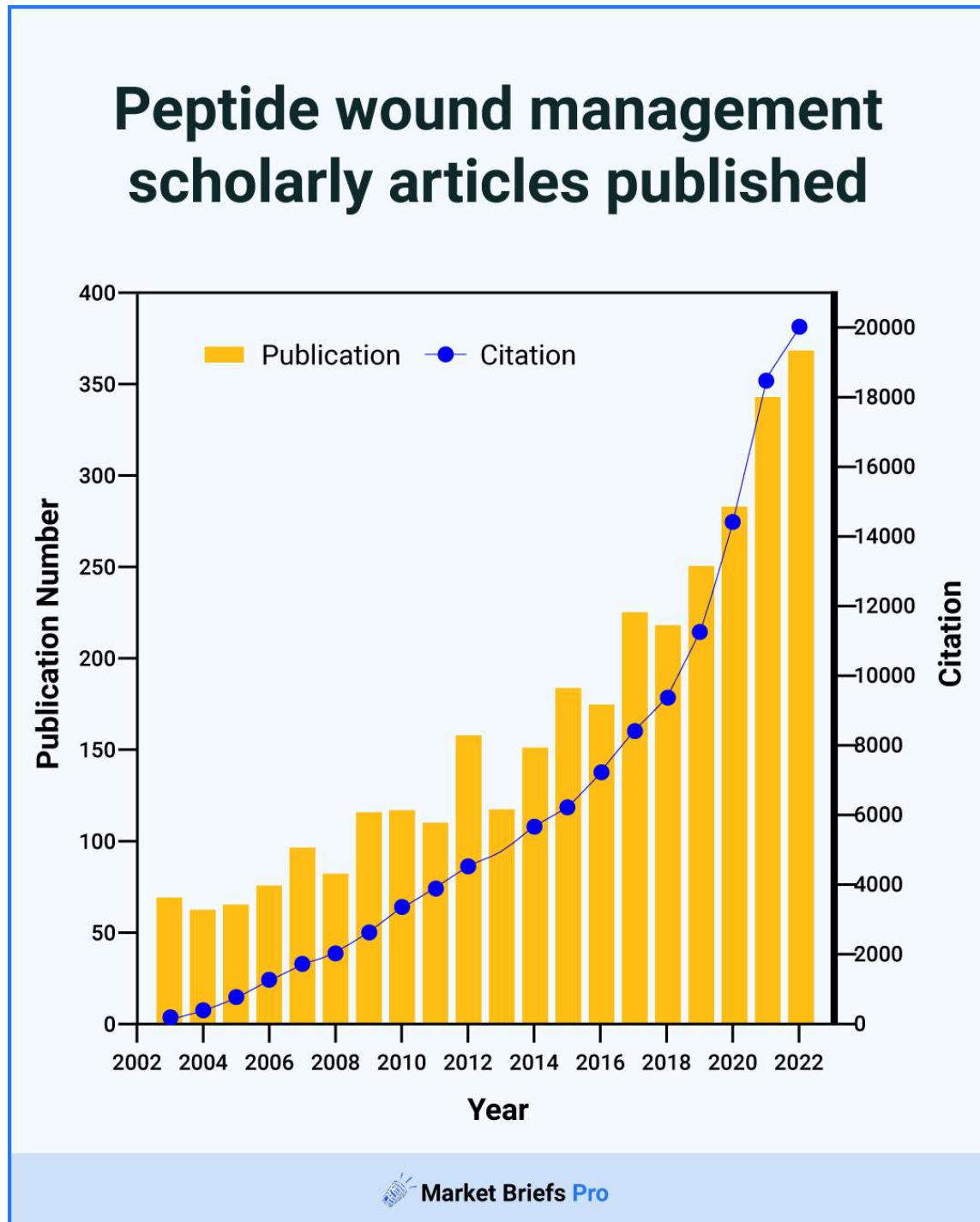
Healing on Hyperspeed

The whole appeal of peptides is that our body already produces them naturally.

But introducing more peptides into our bodies allows our system to do everything it's already doing, but faster.

For instance - peptide medicines may be able to speed up wound healing and tissue regeneration.

A study from Interactive Health Miami found that recovery times for certain surgeries went from 3-6 months to just a few weeks due to the use of peptides.



Data via Wiley

That's why some biotech firms are beginning to put more emphasis on peptides.

"Copper is being sold as a peptide and copper tripeptide is amazing for your mitochondrial health, your DNA synthesis, and just a sort of as a regenerative peptide. Helps a lot with hair health, skin health." - Dr. Del Toro Badessa.

One of those companies is Organogenesis Holdings (ORGO), which has a focus on industries related to sports medicine and after-surgery healing.

In its test groups, Organogenesis Holdings and its peptide products have been able to reduce wound sizes by 64%.

- This medicine utilizes the Copper peptide Dr. Del Toro Badessa mentioned above.

Sales in its wound-care segment grew 12% year-over-year in 2024 and the company as a whole earned \$482 million, up from \$433 million in 2023.

Organogenesis Holdings Inc. (ORGO)

1 Year Price



4.3650
(50.52%)



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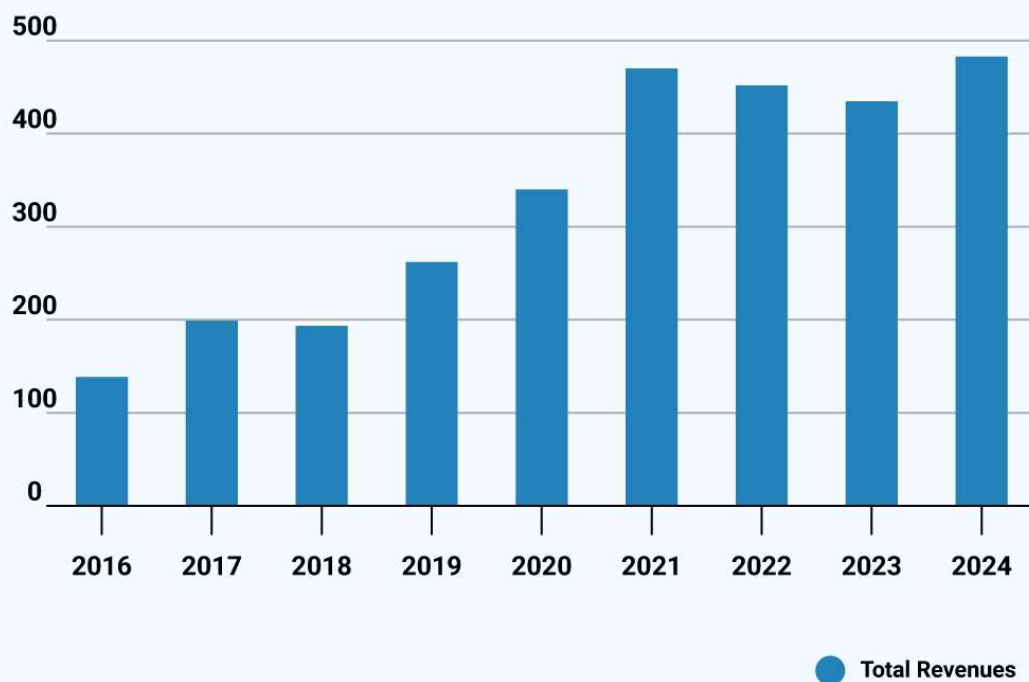
Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

The company also plans on investing another \$50 million into research and development of peptide-based regenerative medicines in 2025, on top of its \$50 million investment in 2024.

Peptides can only help improve what is already in our body - they can't replace a lost limb or tissue.

Organogenesis Holdings Inc. Revenue (ORGO)

Revenue in millions (USD)



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Data [via](#) company 10-K

However, some companies have been able to improve organ and tissue transplants with the help of peptides.

MiMedx (MDXG) is a biotech company working specifically on peptides for organ and tissue health.

Historically, it can take years to fully heal from a major organ transplant, but peptides may be able to cut down that time significantly.

- 92% of patients in MiMedx's studies had faster wound regeneration with its medicine vs. without its medicine.

Some cost-benefit studies have also shown that tissue transplants that heal faster save people money - on average \$3,670 per patient, according to

MiMedx Group, Inc. (MDXG)

5 Year Price → **6.59**
(28.71%)



 Market Briefs Pro

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

What else? It has the largest body of clinical research for its peptides in the world, particularly on how transplants are more successful with its medicine.

- So far, MiMedx has contributed over 3 million peptides for transplants, helping over 300 million patients worldwide.

In 2024, MiMedx earned \$324 million in annual revenue, a 9% increase year-over-year.

And while there aren't any ETFs focused on peptides in regenerative medicine yet, MiMedx and Organogenesis Holdings have emerging as

opportunities for investors.

MiMedx Group, Inc. Revenue (MDXG)

Revenue in millions (USD)



 Market Briefs Pro

Data [via](#) company 10-K

RISKS

Peptide Pitfalls

Investors should keep in mind that the medical and cosmetic spaces are rapidly changing. Peptides may come to replace certain medicines.

But, a new medical innovation could replace peptides - that could hurt the opportunities associated with this shift.

When it comes to cosmetics, trends rapidly change as well, which makes it difficult for companies in this space to maintain steady revenue.

In addition, many of the medicines and products featured in this report are not yet available to the public.

What does that mean? It could be years before we see widespread use of peptides for wound healing and hormonal therapy, meaning this is a long-term shift.

Also, medicine, science, and research all take money to develop. High costs can lower profits for businesses in the peptides space, making profitability difficult.

And of course - when you're dealing with medicines, there's also a health risk to consumers,

"All medications and all supplements do come with risks. Who are the peptides coming from and who's monitoring you? Are you getting interval blood testing?" - Dr. Del Toro Badessa.

REVIEW

The Next Biotech Boom?

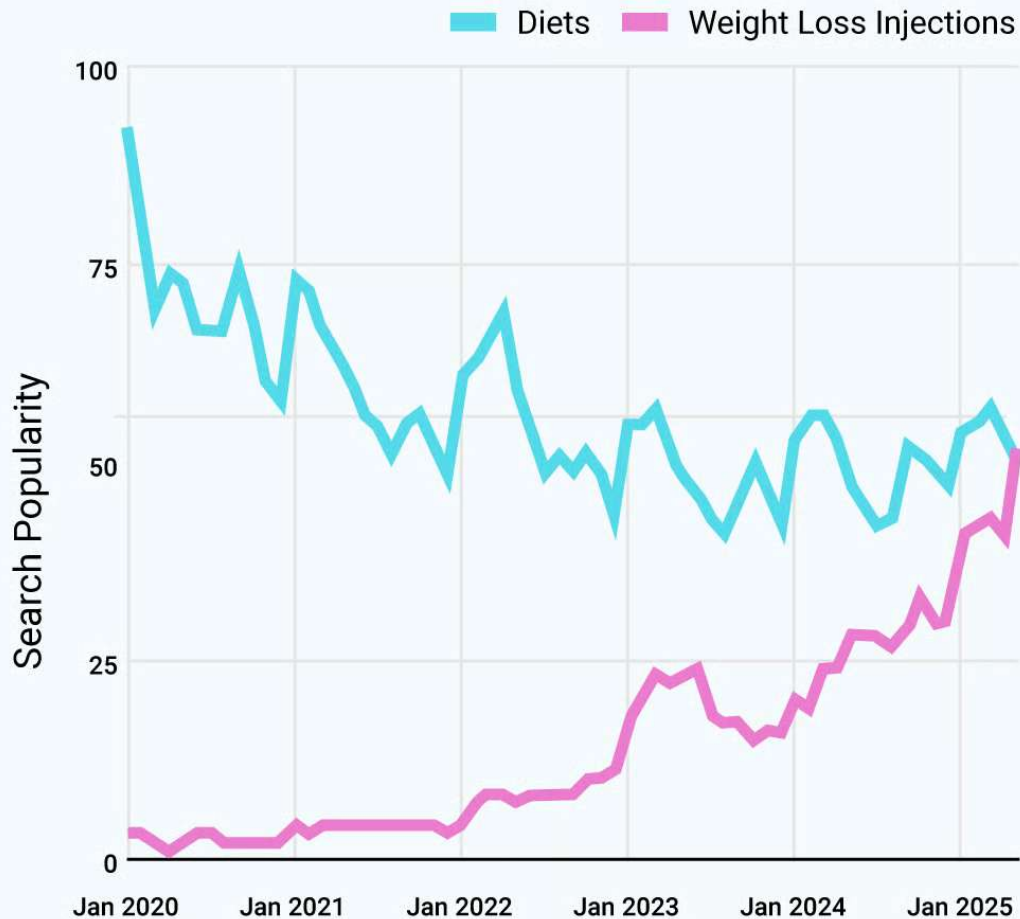
GLP-1s were just the beginning when it comes to peptides - now, researchers are discovering that peptides can be customized to do a lot more to better our health.

"Stroke victims, traumatic brain injuries, Alzheimer's - if we have peptide therapy that can help with the brain remodeling, we're going to unlock an awesome future where we could really help a lot of people, you know, and where we are living longer." Dr. Del Toro Badessa.

That innovation is creating opportunities for investors to profit, as demand increases for peptides in hormonal health, wound regeneration, and skincare.

Search demand for weight loss injections exceeded diets

Google Trends



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Data via [Terakeet](#)

Overall, the peptides industry is expected to grow by 6% each year until 2034 to become a \$130 billion industry, up from \$45 billion today.

But it's still in the growth phase - which means there's always a concern for profitability and products reaching public use.

In any case, investors will want to keep an eye on peptides as they grow in the health space, as this shift slowly bubbles into the mainstream.



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